

QIKO

A Marketing Plan for Ember Kitchen Catering

From Healthy Tingkat to a Standalone B2C Brand

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Disclaimer and Scope

This marketing plan is an independent portfolio exercise. It is not a commissioned report and it was not produced on behalf of Ember Kitchen Catering or any affiliated entity. The company name used in this document is a code name. It does not refer to any specific real organisation.

All financial figures, market estimates, and projections are modelled from publicly available data, industry benchmarks, and reasonable assumptions. They should be read as directional estimates, not audited numbers. Competitor information is drawn from published menus, public social media, and press coverage available at the time of writing.

The plan is designed to demonstrate marketing strategy, brand development, financial modelling, and campaign planning skills across a realistic Singapore market scenario.

This is a development rework made by Virgilio from the original Qiko marketing plan completed by the CAN team. (Original credits awarded)

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1. Executive Summary

Ember Kitchen Catering is a Singapore-based catering company with an estimated annual revenue of S\$2.8 million. The business is built on B2B event catering. Weddings, corporate functions, institutional dining. That side of the operation runs well.

Two years ago, Ember Kitchen launched a B2C meal subscription called Healthy Tingkat. The product uses cook-chill technology to deliver halal-certified, health-conscious meals twice weekly. No lock-in contract. Flexible portions. The food is good. The business model makes sense. The problem is that almost nobody knows it exists.

Healthy Tingkat currently generates roughly S\$180,000 per year, about 6% of total revenue. It sits as a small tab on the Ember Kitchen website, buried under wedding menus and conference packages. The Instagram account is entirely B2B. Event photos. Buffet layouts. Corporate headshots. A 25 year old health-conscious professional looking for meal prep would never find it, because the entire brand speaks to a different audience.

This plan proposes a full rebrand. Healthy Tingkat becomes Qiko (from Mandarin "Qi" meaning vitality). Qiko operates as a standalone B2C brand with its own identity, website, social channels, and positioning. It keeps Ember Kitchen's kitchen infrastructure and halal certification, but everything the customer sees is new.

The strategy covers five pillars. First, the rebrand itself (name, visual identity, tone of voice, packaging). Second, product range expansion (QikoFit for fitness-focused meals, Build-a-Bento for customisation, and a freezable retail line). Third, distribution beyond the website (Cold Storage, Grab, Foodpanda, and eventually a physical presence). Fourth, an HPB (Health Promotion Board) partnership for grants of up to S\$35,000 and the Healthier Choice certification badge. Fifth, a content-led social media strategy built around Instagram, TikTok, and community engagement.

The projected Year 1 marketing budget is S\$32,000, with the possibility of recovering up to S\$35,000 through HPB grants. If the grant applications succeed, the net investment could be close to zero. Year 1 revenue target for Qiko is S\$350,000 to S\$500,000. Year 2, with retail partnerships active, targets S\$600,000 to S\$900,000.

The opportunity is real. Singapore's healthy meal delivery market is growing at roughly 12% annually. The infrastructure already exists. The kitchen is running. The halal certification is in place. What Ember Kitchen needs is not a better product. It needs a better brand.

2. The Organisation

2.1 Company Background

Ember Kitchen Catering was established in Singapore as a halal-certified catering company. The business serves the B2B market, providing catering for weddings, corporate events, conferences, and institutional clients. Estimated annual revenue sits at approximately S\$2.8 million, with a workforce of around 35 full-time staff across kitchen operations, logistics, and administration.

The company holds a valid halal certification from MUIS (Majlis Ugama Islam Singapura), which is a significant operational asset in Singapore's multi-ethnic food market. The central kitchen facility operates at roughly 65% capacity, meaning there is room to scale food production without major capital investment.

2.2 The Healthy Tingkat Product

Healthy Tingkat is Ember Kitchen's B2C meal subscription service. It delivers health-conscious, portion-controlled meals using cook-chill technology. Customers receive meals twice weekly (Monday and Thursday deliveries), with no lock-in commitment. The menu rotates weekly and all meals carry the same halal certification as the core catering business.

Cook-chill is the key differentiator from traditional tingkat providers. Meals are cooked, rapidly chilled to 3 degrees Celsius, and delivered in sealed containers with a five-day refrigerated shelf life. This gives customers more flexibility than the daily delivery model used by traditional tingkat services, where food must be consumed the same day.

Current pricing sits at S\$8.90 per meal for individual orders, S\$89 for a 10-meal plan, and S\$169 for a 20-meal plan. The 20-meal plan works out to S\$8.45 per meal, which positions the product in the middle of the market. Not the cheapest, not the most expensive.

2.3 The Problem

Healthy Tingkat generates roughly S\$180,000 in annual revenue. That sounds reasonable until you realise it represents just 6% of Ember Kitchen's total turnover, after two years of operation. Growth has been slow, averaging around 8% year-on-year. The product is not failing. It is stalling.

The root cause is not the food or the pricing. It is the brand architecture. Healthy Tingkat does not have its own identity. It exists as a subsection of a B2B catering website. The Instagram account (the primary discovery channel for food brands in Singapore) posts corporate event photos. The visual language is corporate catering. The tone is professional and formal. None of this speaks to a 28 year old professional looking for convenient, healthy meal prep.

In practical terms, Ember Kitchen is trying to sell a consumer product through a business-to-business shopfront. The product is in the wrong building. This plan is about giving it the right one.

3. Market Analysis

3.1 Singapore Healthy Meal Delivery Market

Singapore's online food delivery market was valued at approximately US\$1.6 billion in 2024, with healthy meal subscriptions representing a growing subsegment. The broader health and wellness food market in Singapore has been expanding at roughly 8 to 12% annually, driven by rising health consciousness, an ageing population, and government initiatives through the Health Promotion Board.

Several factors make Singapore a strong market for healthy meal delivery. The country has one of the highest smartphone penetration rates globally (over 90%). Average working hours are long (44.6 hours per week according to MOM data), which creates demand for convenient meal solutions. The government actively promotes healthy eating through the Healthier SG initiative, the Healthier Dining Programme, and the Nutri-Grade labelling system.

The total addressable market for ready-to-eat healthy meals in Singapore is estimated at S\$380 million to S\$450 million annually, including meal subscriptions, grab-and-go healthy options, and health-focused food delivery. The meal subscription subsegment, where Qiko would compete, is estimated at S\$80 million to S\$120 million.

3.2 Competitive Analysis

The Singapore healthy meal delivery market has several established players. Each occupies a slightly different position, but the space is crowded and differentiation is often superficial.

Competitor	Price Point	Positioning	Strengths	Weaknesses
Grain	~S\$9.95/meal	Premium healthy meals, curated menus	Strong brand, good social media, office delivery network	Higher price, limited customisation, no halal cert for all items
AMGD	~S\$8.90/meal	Affordable health meals, calorie-counted	Clear nutritional labelling, competitive price	Less brand recognition, basic packaging
YOLO Foods	~S\$13.90/day	Fitness-focused, macro-counted	Strong fitness community, detailed macros	Expensive, niche audience, not halal
Yummy Bros	~S\$7.00/meal	Budget fitness meals, high protein	Cheapest option, large portions, good protein content	Basic presentation, limited variety, male-skewing brand
Traditional Tingkat	S\$5-7/day	Home-style daily meals, heritage	Cheapest, familiar format, daily fresh delivery	Not health-focused, no nutritional data, limited shelf life

The competitive gap is visible. No single player combines halal certification, mid-range pricing, cook-chill convenience (longer shelf life than traditional tingkat), and HPB-endorsed health credentials. That gap is where Qiko fits.

3.3 Market Trends

Health Consciousness

The Singapore Health Promotion Board reported that 7 in 10 Singaporeans expressed a desire to eat healthier in their 2023 National Nutrition Survey. This is not a niche segment. It is the mainstream. The challenge is converting intent into behaviour, and convenience is the biggest barrier. People want to eat well. They do not want to meal prep for three hours on a Sunday.

Government Health Initiatives

Singapore's Healthier SG initiative launched in 2023 and ties preventive health to primary care. The Healthier Dining Programme offers grants of up to S\$30,000 for food businesses that introduce healthier menu options. The Nutri-Grade labelling system (mandatory for beverages, expanding to food) signals the government's direction. Brands that align with HPB early gain a credibility advantage that is difficult for competitors to replicate quickly.

Meal Delivery Growth

Food delivery platforms (Grab, Foodpanda, Deliveroo) have normalised ordering meals online. The infrastructure already exists. Consumer behaviour has already shifted. The question for Qiko is not whether people will order healthy meals online. They already do. The question is whether Qiko can make itself the one they choose.

3.4 Target Market

The primary target market is health-conscious professionals aged 22 to 45 in Singapore. This segment values convenience, nutritional transparency, and taste. They are digitally native, active on Instagram and TikTok, and willing to pay a moderate premium for meals that save them time without compromising on health.

Persona 1. Priya, 28, Marketing Manager

Priya works in the CBD. She finishes at 7pm most days and does not have the energy to cook. She currently alternates between Grab orders and the occasional Grain delivery, spending roughly S\$15 to S\$20 per dinner. She wants something healthier and cheaper than her current routine, but she will not sacrifice taste. She follows food accounts on Instagram and discovers new brands through Stories and Reels. Halal certification matters to her because she often shares meals with colleagues.

Persona 2. Jason, 34, Software Engineer

Jason trains at the gym four days a week and tracks his macros loosely. He has used Yummy Bros and YOLO Foods but finds them repetitive. He wants variety in his high-protein meals without having to spend S\$14 per serving. He would pay S\$9 to S\$10 per meal for something that hits his protein targets and tastes good enough that he does not dread opening the container. He discovers products through Reddit, TikTok, and word of mouth at his gym.

Persona 3. Mei Ling, 42, Working Mother

Mei Ling has two school-age children and works part-time. She handles family meals and is tired of the daily "what to cook" cycle. She values the traditional tingkat format (familiar, practical) but wants healthier options with proper nutritional information. She is less price-sensitive than the younger

personas but very quality-conscious. She uses Facebook more than Instagram and trusts recommendations from parent community groups.

4. SWOT Analysis

The SWOT analysis below assesses Ember Kitchen's position specifically for the Qiko rebrand and B2C market entry. It is not a general assessment of the catering business.

Strengths	Weaknesses
Existing halal-certified kitchen infrastructure with spare capacity (approx. 35% headroom). Cook-chill technology already operational. Two years of B2C operational experience with Healthy Tingkat. Established supply chain relationships with food suppliers. MUIS halal certification (significant competitive moat in Singapore). Low marginal cost per additional meal due to shared kitchen.	No standalone B2C brand identity. Zero social media presence targeting consumers. Website is B2B-focused with no B2C user experience. No HPB Healthier Choice certification yet. No presence on food delivery platforms. Limited marketing expertise in-house (team is operations-focused). No customer data or CRM system for B2C segment.
Opportunities	Threats
HPB Healthier Dining Grant (up to S\$30,000) and Innovation Grant (up to S\$5,000) available. Growing health consciousness among Singapore consumers (70% want to eat healthier, HPB 2023). Meal delivery infrastructure mature (Grab, Foodpanda). Retail grocery partnership potential (Cold Storage, Little Farms). Corporate wellness programmes increasingly include meal subscriptions. Underserved halal segment in the premium healthy meal space.	Established competitors with stronger brand awareness (Grain, YOLO Foods). Price sensitivity in the mid-market segment. Rising food costs and supply chain pressures. Potential new entrants from traditional food companies diversifying into healthy meals. Consumer fatigue with meal subscription models (high churn rates industry-wide, typically 15-25% monthly). Delivery logistics costs in Singapore remain high.

The picture that emerges is clear. The internal fundamentals are strong (kitchen, certification, experience) but the external-facing elements (brand, digital, distribution) are weak or missing entirely. The opportunities are genuine and time-sensitive, particularly the HPB grants. The threats are real but manageable. This is not a situation where the business needs to be rebuilt. It needs to be repackaged.

5. Strategic Framework

5.1 Ansoff's Matrix

Ansoff's Matrix provides a useful frame for understanding what Qiko is actually doing strategically. The rebrand sits across two quadrants simultaneously.

The core Healthy Tingkat product, rebranded as Qiko, is a market development play. The product already exists. The strategy is to reach a new audience (health-conscious young professionals) through new channels (standalone website, social media, food delivery apps) and a new brand identity. The product itself changes only incrementally.

The new product ranges (QikoFit, Build-a-Bento, freezable retail line) sit in the product development quadrant. Same target market, new product variations designed to address specific needs within that market.

The plan deliberately avoids the diversification quadrant. Ember Kitchen is not entering a new industry or targeting a fundamentally different customer type. The B2C healthy meal market is adjacent to what the company already does. That adjacency reduces risk.

5.2 Positioning Strategy

The positioning matrix maps competitors on two axes. The horizontal axis runs from "Basic/Traditional" to "Modern/Health-Tech." The vertical axis runs from "Budget" to "Premium."

Traditional tingkat providers sit in the bottom-left (budget, traditional). Yummy Bros sits slightly above them (budget, moderately modern). AMGD occupies the centre-left (mid-price, moderate health positioning). Grain sits in the upper-right (premium, modern). YOLO Foods sits at the top-right (premium, fitness-tech).

Qiko's target position is centre-right. Modern, health-tech positioning (HPB certified, nutritional data, cook-chill technology) at a mid-range price point (S\$8.50 to S\$10.50 per meal). This positions Qiko below Grain and YOLO on price, but above traditional tingkat and Yummy Bros on health credentials and brand sophistication.

The key positioning statement for Qiko would be something close to this. "Meals that actually fuel you. Halal certified. HPB endorsed. Delivered." Short, specific, and built on claims that competitors cannot easily match (the halal plus HPB combination is currently unoccupied in the market).

5.3 Product Portfolio (BCG Matrix)

Applying the BCG Matrix to Qiko's planned product portfolio gives a useful view of where to invest and where to hold.

The core Qiko meal subscription is the star candidate. High growth potential (healthy meal market growing at 12%), moderate market share target (3-5% of the subscription segment in Year 1). This gets the bulk of marketing investment.

QikoFit (fitness-focused meals with macro-counted nutrition) is a question mark. The fitness meal segment is competitive (YOLO, Yummy Bros), but the halal-certified gap remains open. Worth testing with limited investment.

Build-a-Bento (customisable meal boxes) is also a question mark. Customisation is operationally complex, but consumer demand for personalisation is strong. Pilot with a limited menu before full rollout.

The freezable retail line (for grocery partnerships) is a cash cow candidate in Year 2. Lower margin per unit but high volume potential and low marketing cost (the retailer provides the distribution and foot traffic).

6. The Rebrand

6.1 Why Rebrand

The argument for rebranding Healthy Tingkat as Qiko rests on a single observation. The product is good. The brand is wrong.

"Healthy Tingkat" as a name does three things that hold the product back. First, it anchors the product to the traditional tingkat format (daily home-style meals in stackable containers), which creates expectations around price and presentation that the product cannot meet. Traditional tingkat is S\$5 to S\$7 per day. Healthy Tingkat is S\$8.90 per meal. The name invites an unfavourable price comparison before the customer has learned what makes the product different.

Second, "Healthy" as a prefix has become almost meaningless in the food market. Every brand claims to be healthy. It does not differentiate. It is a category descriptor, not a brand name.

Third, "Healthy Tingkat" cannot stand alone. It makes sense as a sub-product of Ember Kitchen Catering. It does not make sense as the name of a standalone Instagram account, a retail product on a Cold Storage shelf, or a brand that someone tells their friend about at the gym.

6.2 The Qiko Brand

Name and Meaning

Qiko (pronounced "chee-ko") derives from the Mandarin word "Qi" (meaning vitality, life force, energy). The name is short, memorable, phonetically clean across English and Mandarin, and carries a meaning that connects directly to health and energy without being literal about it. It sounds like a brand, not a product description.

Brand Personality

Qiko is warm, grounded, and quietly confident. It does not shout about superfoods or detox cleanses. It is the friend who cooks well and makes it look easy. The brand respects food traditions (especially Singaporean and Southeast Asian cuisines) while presenting them in a modern, clean format. It takes health seriously without making it feel like a chore.

Positioning Statement

For health-conscious professionals in Singapore who want convenient, genuinely nutritious meals, Qiko is the halal-certified meal subscription that combines cook-chill freshness, HPB-endorsed nutrition, and real flavour. Unlike premium competitors, Qiko delivers at a mid-range price. Unlike budget options, Qiko provides full nutritional transparency and modern packaging.

Visual Identity Direction

The visual identity breaks away from Ember Kitchen's corporate catering aesthetic entirely. The primary colour is a vibrant teal green (#1A9E8F), which communicates health and freshness without defaulting to the overused "green salad" palette. The accent colour is warm coral (#E8734A), which brings energy and appetite appeal. Background tones use off-white (#FAF7F2) with charcoal text (#2D2D2D).

Typography should be clean and modern. A geometric sans-serif for headlines (something like Poppins or Nunito Sans) paired with a readable body font (Inter or Source Sans Pro). No script fonts. No ornamental elements. The look should feel like a health-tech brand, not a traditional food company.

Packaging uses matte cardboard with the teal and coral palette, clear nutritional labelling on the front (not hidden on the back), and a window or photograph showing the actual food. The unboxing experience matters. First impressions on Instagram happen when customers photograph their delivery.

Tone of Voice

Qiko speaks in short, clear sentences. Friendly but not try-hard. It knows its product is good and does not need to oversell. It avoids fitness industry jargon ("gains," "macros," "shredding") unless speaking directly to that audience segment (the QikoFit range). It uses food language that is specific and appealing. "Turmeric coconut chicken with jasmine rice" is better than "protein-packed healthy bowl."

7. Marketing Mix

7.1 Product

Core Range (Qiko Meals)

The core product remains the twice-weekly meal subscription using cook-chill technology. Meals are halal-certified, nutritionally balanced, and designed to be reheated in under 5 minutes. The menu rotates weekly, with 8 to 10 options per cycle. Each meal includes full nutritional information (calories, protein, carbohydrates, fat, sodium) printed on the container and available on the website.

Portion sizes follow HPB guidelines (roughly 500 to 650 calories for a main meal). This matters because it aligns with the Healthier Choice certification criteria and differentiates from competitors who either under-portion (to hit calorie targets) or over-portion (to justify premium pricing).

QikoFit Range

QikoFit is a targeted sub-range for the fitness-conscious segment. Meals are macro-counted (minimum 35g protein per serving), lower in refined carbohydrates, and designed around post-workout recovery. The range launches with 4 options per weekly cycle. Pricing is S\$10.50 per meal (a S\$1.60 premium over the core range, justified by higher protein content and portion sizes).

Build-a-Bento

Build-a-Bento introduces customisation. Customers choose a base (rice, noodles, or salad), a protein (chicken, fish, tofu, or egg), and two sides from a rotating selection. This addresses the variety fatigue that drives churn in meal subscriptions. It also provides operational flexibility, as components can be prepared in bulk and assembled to order. Launch as a pilot with limited combinations before expanding.

Freezable Retail Line

The freezable retail line is designed for grocery distribution. These are single-serve frozen meals in retail-friendly packaging, priced at S\$6.90 to S\$8.90. The target shelf is the chilled/frozen ready-meals section at Cold Storage, Little Farms, and selected FairPrice Finest outlets. This product line launches in Year 2, once the brand has been established through the subscription service.

7.2 Price

Pricing strategy is mid-market positioning with a tiered structure designed to encourage commitment without requiring lock-in.

Plan	Price	Per Meal	Savings vs Single
Single meal	S\$8.90	S\$8.90	Baseline
10-meal plan	S\$85.00	S\$8.50	4.5%
20-meal plan	S\$162.00	S\$8.10	9.0%
QikoFit (single)	S\$10.50	S\$10.50	Premium range
QikoFit (10-meal)	S\$99.00	S\$9.90	5.7%

Launch promotions include a "First Week Free" offer for the first 200 subscribers (cost to Ember Kitchen approximately S\$3,400, treated as customer acquisition cost). A referral programme gives both the referrer and the new customer S\$10 credit. Corporate packages for offices ordering 10+ meals daily are priced at S\$7.50 per meal.

7.3 Place (Distribution)

Direct-to-Consumer (Website)

The primary channel is a standalone Qiko website (not a subsection of Ember Kitchen's site). The website handles ordering, subscription management, menu browsing, and nutritional information. It needs to work well on mobile, because over 75% of food delivery orders in Singapore originate from mobile devices.

Food Delivery Platforms

Qiko should list on Grab Food and Foodpanda within 3 months of the rebrand launch. These platforms charge 25 to 30% commission, which compresses margins, but they provide discovery and reach that the standalone website cannot match in Year 1. Pricing on platforms is set at S\$9.90 per meal (a S\$1.00 premium over website ordering) to offset commission costs and incentivise direct ordering.

Retail Grocery Partnership

In Year 2, the freezable retail line targets Cold Storage and Little Farms. These retailers already stock premium ready meals and have health-conscious customer bases. The pitch is straightforward. Qiko offers a halal-certified, HPB-endorsed ready meal that fills a gap in their chilled/frozen section. Initial target is 10 to 15 stores.

Physical Presence

The longer-term vision (Year 2 onwards) includes a small physical presence. Not a full restaurant. Something closer to a grab-and-go counter or a food truck at high-traffic locations (CBD lunch spots, gym clusters, university campuses). This gives the brand a physical touchpoint, generates social media content, and allows sampling. Budget and timing depend on Year 1 results.

7.4 Promotion

Social Media

Instagram is the primary platform. The account is built from scratch as @qiko.sg (not a rebrand of the existing Ember Kitchen account). Content strategy is detailed in Section 8. TikTok is the secondary platform, focusing on short-form video (meal prep, behind-the-kitchen, taste tests). Facebook targets the older demographic (Persona 3, Mei Ling) through community groups and targeted advertising.

Influencer Strategy

The influencer approach prioritises micro-influencers (5,000 to 50,000 followers) over celebrity partnerships. Micro-influencers in the Singapore food and fitness space deliver higher engagement rates (typically 3 to 7% versus under 1% for macro-influencers) and cost between S\$200 and S\$800 per post. The target is 15 to 20 influencer partnerships in Year 1, spread across food, fitness, and working-professional categories.

One premium collaboration per quarter with a local chef or nutritionist. These produce co-branded menu items ("Chef X's Laksa Bowl by Qiko") that generate press coverage and provide content for 2 to 3 weeks of social media.

HPB Partnership

The HPB Healthier Choice certification badge is the most valuable promotional asset in the plan. It provides third-party credibility that no amount of self-promotion can match. Details in Section 9.

PR and Media

A launch press kit targets food media (Seth Lui, DanielFoodDiary, Eatbook, Miss Tam Chiak) and lifestyle publications (Her World, August Man, The Smart Local). The angle is not "new meal delivery service" (that is not news). The angle is "B2B catering company creates standalone health brand, backed by HPB." That is a story.

7.5 People

The rebrand requires one key hire. A part-time digital marketing and brand manager (approximately 20 hours per week, S\$2,500 to S\$3,500 per month). This person handles social media management, content creation, influencer coordination, and campaign execution. The existing kitchen team handles food production. The existing logistics team handles delivery.

A freelance food photographer and videographer is needed for the first month (brand asset creation) and then on a recurring basis (2 to 3 shoots per month for ongoing content). Budget is S\$300 to S\$500 per shoot.

7.6 Process

The customer journey needs to be frictionless. Order on the website or app. Choose your meals. Confirm delivery day (Monday or Thursday). Receive meals in insulated packaging. Reheat in 4 minutes. The process that matters most is the first order experience, because that determines whether the customer returns.

Operationally, the cook-chill process is already established. The additional volume from Qiko slots into the existing kitchen schedule. Delivery logistics use a combination of in-house drivers (for clustered CBD orders) and a third-party cold-chain logistics partner (for island-wide residential delivery). The logistics cost per delivery is estimated at S\$3.50 to S\$5.00, depending on distance and order size.

7.7 Physical Evidence

Physical evidence is where the Qiko brand comes alive. Every touchpoint the customer interacts with needs to feel like Qiko, not Ember Kitchen.

Packaging is the most important physical evidence. The meal containers carry the Qiko brand, the teal and coral colour scheme, and clear nutritional labelling on the front. The delivery box is matte cardboard with the Qiko logo and a small card inside ("Your Qiko this week" with the menu and nutritional summary). It needs to be photogenic, because customers will share their first delivery on Instagram Stories.

The website is the second most important physical evidence. It must look and feel like a standalone brand. No Ember Kitchen branding visible. Clean, modern design. Fast loading on mobile. Easy reordering. The "About Us" page can mention the Ember Kitchen kitchen infrastructure (this provides credibility) but the brand identity is entirely Qiko.

The HPB Healthier Choice badge (once obtained) goes on every piece of packaging, the website header, and every social media bio. It is the single most powerful piece of physical evidence available.

8. Content Strategy

8.1 Platform Strategy

Instagram (Primary)

Instagram is where Singaporean food brands live or die. The @qiko.sg account launches with a pre-built grid of 15 to 18 posts before the public launch, so the profile looks established from day one. Posting cadence is 4 to 5 feed posts per week, 7 to 10 Stories per week, and 2 to 3 Reels per week.

TikTok (Secondary)

TikTok targets the 18 to 30 demographic with short-form video content. Behind-the-kitchen footage, 60-second recipe breakdowns, taste-test reactions, and "what I eat in a day" collaborations with influencers. Posting cadence is 3 to 4 videos per week. TikTok is a discovery engine, not a conversion platform. The goal is brand awareness, not direct sales.

Facebook

Facebook targets the 35 to 50 demographic (Persona 3). Activity focuses on community groups (Singapore Mummies, Halal Food Singapore, Healthy Eating SG) and targeted advertising. Posting cadence is 3 to 4 posts per week. Facebook is also where customer service interactions tend to happen for this demographic.

8.2 Content Pillars

Pillar	Share	Description	Example Posts
Food Showcase	35%	Beautiful food photography. The hero content. Every post should make someone hungry.	Meal flat-lays, close-up shots, ingredient highlights, menu reveals
Behind the Kitchen	20%	The human side. Kitchen prep, team introductions, the cook-chill process, sourcing stories.	Chef at work, morning prep time-lapse, supplier visit, packaging line
Nutrition and Health	20%	Educational content. Meal comparisons, nutritional breakdowns, HPB tips, myth-busting.	"What 500 calories actually looks like", macro comparisons, HPB facts
Community and UGC	15%	Customer stories, reviews, unboxing reposts, user-generated content.	Customer meal photos, testimonials, "Qiko of the week" feature
Brand and Lifestyle	10%	Brand values, Singapore culture, sustainability, seasonal content.	National Day special, sustainability initiatives, team celebrations

8.3 User-Generated Content Strategy

UGC is the most cost-effective content source and the most credible. The strategy centres on making the unboxing experience photogenic (packaging design matters here) and encouraging sharing through two mechanisms.

First, a branded hashtag (#MyQiko) with a monthly prize draw. Every customer who posts a photo of their Qiko meal with the hashtag is entered to win a free month of meals. Cost is roughly S\$170 per month (20 free meals), and the content generated is worth far more than that.

Second, a "Qiko Creator" programme for customers who consistently produce good content. They receive free meals in exchange for regular posting. Target is 10 to 15 active Qiko Creators by the end of Year 1.

9. HPB Partnership Strategy

The Health Promotion Board partnership is the single highest-impact element of this plan. It provides three things that money alone cannot buy. Credibility, grants, and campaign access.

9.1 Healthier Choice Certification

The Healthier Choice Symbol (HCS) is awarded to food products that meet specific nutritional criteria set by HPB. For ready meals, this typically means limits on calories (under 700 kcal), sodium (under 800mg), saturated fat (under 8g), and added sugar, with minimum requirements for whole grains, fruits, and vegetables where applicable.

Qiko's existing meals are close to meeting these criteria. The cook-chill process uses minimal added oil, and portion sizes already align with HPB guidelines. The main adjustments required are likely sodium reduction (a common issue in prepared meals) and reformulation of 2 to 3 menu items to increase vegetable content.

Estimated timeline for HCS certification is 3 to 6 months from application. The application process involves submitting detailed nutritional analyses and undergoing a review by HPB's nutrition team. Cost is primarily in the nutritional testing (approximately S\$200 to S\$400 per menu item through accredited labs).

9.2 Grant Opportunities

Healthier Dining Programme Grant

The Healthier Dining Programme (HDP) provides grants of up to S\$30,000 for food businesses that introduce or expand healthier menu options. The grant covers costs related to menu reformulation, nutritional analysis, marketing of healthier options, and staff training. Qiko qualifies as a new healthier brand launch from an existing food business.

The S\$30,000 grant alone would cover approximately 75 to 95% of the Year 1 marketing budget (depending on final budget allocation). This is not a marginal benefit. It fundamentally changes the economics of the launch.

Innovation Grant

HPB's Innovation Grant (up to S\$5,000) supports creative approaches to promoting healthier eating. The Qiko application would focus on the cook-chill technology as an innovation in making healthier meals more accessible and convenient. The grant is smaller but the application process is lighter.

9.3 Campaign Participation

HPB runs several national campaigns throughout the year that Qiko should participate in. The "Eat, Drink, Shop Healthy" challenge encourages Singaporeans to make healthier food choices and provides marketing amplification through HPB's own channels. The "Healthier Hawker" and "Healthier Dining" campaigns provide co-branding opportunities where Qiko would be featured alongside HPB's trusted brand.

These campaigns provide two things that are difficult to purchase. Access to HPB's communication channels (which reach millions of Singaporeans) and an implicit government endorsement of the brand's health claims. For a new brand, this credibility signal is worth more than the direct marketing reach.

10. Budget and Financial Model

10.1 Year 1 Marketing Budget

Category	Budget (\$\$)	Notes
Brand identity and design	6,500	Logo, packaging, brand guidelines, photography (initial shoot)
Website build	4,000	Standalone Qiko website with ordering system, mobile-first
Social media (content and management)	8,000	Content creation, scheduling tools, ongoing photography
HPB application and menu adjustment	2,500	Nutritional testing, menu reformulation, application costs
Influencer partnerships	4,000	15-20 micro-influencer posts, 2-4 chef collaborations
Packaging redesign	2,500	New containers, delivery boxes, inserts, labels
Digital advertising	2,000	Instagram and Facebook ads, Google search (limited)
Launch promotions	1,500	"First Week Free" for 200 subscribers, referral credits
Contingency	1,000	Unexpected costs, opportunity fund
Total Year 1 Budget	32,000	
Less HPB grants (estimated)	(25,000)	Conservative estimate (\$\$20K HDP + \$\$5K Innovation)
Net Year 1 Investment	7,000	If grants approved. Worst case (no grants) is \$\$32,000.

10.2 Revenue Projections

Revenue projections are based on conservative subscriber growth assumptions. The model assumes a 20% monthly churn rate (industry average for meal subscriptions is 15 to 25%), offset by new subscriber acquisition.

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Notes
Active weekly subscribers (end of year)	280	520	Net of churn
Average meals per subscriber per week	4.2	4.5	Mix of plans
Average revenue per meal	\$\$8.65	\$\$8.80	Blended across plans
DTC subscription revenue	\$\$310,000	\$\$530,000	Primary channel
Food delivery platform revenue	\$\$45,000	\$\$95,000	Grab, Foodpanda
Retail revenue (frozen line)	\$\$0	\$\$120,000	Launches Year 2
Corporate packages	\$\$25,000	\$\$55,000	Office orders

Total Qiko Revenue	S\$380,000	S\$800,000	
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10.3 Customer Acquisition Cost

Total Year 1 marketing spend is S\$32,000. If the brand acquires 900 unique customers over the year (accounting for churn, meaning not all 900 are active simultaneously), the customer acquisition cost is approximately S\$35.50 per customer. The average customer lifetime value (assuming 4 months average retention at S\$145 per month) is approximately S\$580. The LTV-to-CAC ratio is roughly 16x, which is strong.

These numbers improve significantly if HPB grants are approved. With S\$25,000 in grants, the net marketing spend drops to S\$7,000 and the effective CAC falls to S\$7.80 per customer.

10.4 ROI Analysis

The food cost (ingredients, preparation, packaging) for Qiko meals is estimated at 40 to 45% of revenue. Delivery logistics add 8 to 12%. Platform commissions (for food delivery app orders only) add 25 to 30% on that channel. Overhead allocation from Ember Kitchen's existing operations is estimated at 15%.

On a gross margin basis, the DTC channel delivers approximately 35 to 40% margin. The food delivery platform channel delivers approximately 10 to 15% margin (commission compressed). The retail channel (Year 2) is estimated at 20 to 25% margin.

Blended Year 1 gross profit (primarily DTC) is estimated at S\$130,000 to S\$150,000 on S\$380,000 revenue. After marketing costs (S\$32,000 gross, S\$7,000 net of grants), the Year 1 contribution is estimated at S\$98,000 to S\$143,000. This is a significant step up from Healthy Tingkat's current S\$180,000 revenue at lower margins.

11. Implementation Timeline

Phase 1. Foundation (Months 1 to 3)

This phase is about building everything the customer will see before they see it. No public launch until the brand is ready.

Task	Timeline	Owner	Dependencies
Finalise brand identity (logo, colours, guidelines)	Weeks 1-3	Brand manager	None
Design and produce new packaging	Weeks 2-6	Brand manager	Brand identity
Build Qiko website	Weeks 2-8	Web developer	Brand identity
Professional food photography shoot	Week 4	Photographer	Packaging
Submit HPB Healthier Choice application	Week 4	Operations	Nutritional testing
Submit HPB grant applications	Week 5	Brand manager	HCS application
Set up @qiko.sg Instagram, TikTok, Facebook	Weeks 6-8	Brand manager	Photography
Pre-build Instagram grid (15-18 posts)	Weeks 8-10	Brand manager	Photography, social setup
Recruit first 10 micro-influencers	Weeks 8-12	Brand manager	Social setup

Phase 2. Launch (Months 4 to 6)

The brand goes live. First customers come in. The content engine starts running.

Task	Timeline	Owner	Dependencies
Public launch of Qiko brand	Month 4, Week 1	All	Phase 1 complete
Activate "First Week Free" promotion	Month 4	Brand manager	Website live
Send press kit to food media	Month 4, Week 1	Brand manager	Launch
First influencer posts go live	Months 4-5	Influencers	Recruitment
Launch referral programme	Month 4, Week 2	Brand manager	Website
List on Grab Food	Month 5	Operations	Brand assets
List on Foodpanda	Month 5	Operations	Brand assets
Launch #MyQiko UGC campaign	Month 5	Brand manager	Active customers
First monthly performance review	Month 5	Brand manager	Data collection

Phase 3. Growth (Months 7 to 12)

Subscriber numbers build. The content calendar is established. Distribution expands.

Task	Timeline	Owner	Dependencies
Launch QikoFit range	Month 7	Operations + Brand	Core stable

Pilot Build-a-Bento (limited menu)	Month 8	Operations	QikoFit feedback
First chef collaboration menu	Month 8	Brand manager	Chef partnership
Begin retail partnership conversations	Month 9	Brand manager	HPB cert, brand traction
HPB Healthier Choice certification (expected)	Month 9-10	Operations	HPB process
Corporate wellness programme outreach	Month 10	Brand manager	HPB badge
Launch Qiko Creator programme	Month 10	Brand manager	Active UGC base
Year 1 performance review and Year 2 planning	Month 12	All	Full year data

Phase 4. Scale (Year 2)

Year 2 is about expanding what works and launching the retail channel.

Key Year 2 milestones include the freezable retail line launch in Cold Storage (target Month 14 to 16), expansion to 15 retail locations by end of Year 2, physical presence pilot (food truck or grab-and-go counter, Month 18), expanded influencer chef collaboration programme (one collaboration per month), and Build-a-Bento full rollout if the pilot succeeds.

12. KPIs and Measurement Framework

Every metric listed below is tied to a specific objective, has a target, and has a measurement method. Numbers without context are not KPIs. They are decoration.

KPI	Target (Year 1)	Measurement	Review Frequency	Linked To
Active weekly subscribers	280 by Month 12	Website analytics	Weekly	Revenue
Monthly recurring revenue	S\$40,000 by Month 12	Accounting system	Monthly	Revenue
Customer acquisition cost	Under S\$40	Marketing spend / new customers	Monthly	Efficiency
Monthly churn rate	Under 20%	Cancellation tracking	Monthly	Retention
Instagram followers	5,000 by Month 12	Instagram analytics	Weekly	Awareness
Instagram engagement rate	Above 4%	Likes + comments / followers	Weekly	Engagement
Website conversion rate	Above 3%	Google Analytics	Monthly	Conversion
HPB certification	Achieved by Month 10	Application status	Monthly	Credibility
Referral rate	15% of new customers	Referral code tracking	Monthly	Word of mouth
Food delivery platform orders	150 per month by Month 12	Platform dashboards	Weekly	Distribution

Performance reviews happen monthly for the first 6 months, then quarterly once patterns are established. Each review compares actual performance against targets, identifies the reasons for any variance, and adjusts tactics (not strategy) accordingly.

13. Risk Assessment

Every plan contains assumptions. The ones below are the assumptions most likely to break, along with the impact if they do and the response if that happens.

Risk 1. HPB Grant Application Fails

Likelihood. Medium. HPB grants are competitive and not guaranteed.

Impact. High. Without the S\$25,000 to S\$35,000 in grants, the net Year 1 investment jumps from S\$7,000 to S\$32,000. Still manageable for Ember Kitchen, but it changes the payback period.

Response. Proceed with the rebrand regardless. The HPB grants improve the economics but they are not the reason to do this. Cut the budget to S\$22,000 by reducing influencer spend and digital advertising. Delay non-essential items. Reapply in the next grant cycle.

Risk 2. Retail Partnership Does Not Materialise

Likelihood. Medium. Cold Storage and similar retailers have established supplier processes and shelf space is competitive.

Impact. Moderate. Year 2 revenue target drops from S\$800,000 to approximately S\$680,000 (removing the S\$120,000 retail projection).

Response. Focus DTC growth more aggressively. Explore alternative retail channels (RedMart online, specialty health stores, gym partnerships). The brand does not depend on retail. It benefits from it.

Risk 3. High Customer Churn

Likelihood. High. Meal subscription churn rates of 15 to 25% per month are industry standard. Menu fatigue is the primary driver.

Impact. High. If churn exceeds 25% monthly, subscriber growth stalls and acquisition costs eat into margins.

Response. Build-a-Bento directly addresses menu fatigue through customisation. Regular menu rotation (weekly changes, seasonal specials). Loyalty programme for long-term subscribers (free meal after every 20th order). Win-back campaigns for lapsed subscribers (come back for a free meal). The response to churn is built into the product strategy, not added as an afterthought.

Risk 4. Competitive Response

Likelihood. Medium. If Qiko gains traction, competitors (especially Grain and AMGD) may respond with halal ranges or price cuts.

Impact. Moderate. Price competition would compress margins. A competitor launching a halal range would reduce Qiko's differentiation.

Response. The HPB certification and the Ember Kitchen kitchen infrastructure are structural advantages that take time to replicate. A competitor cannot get halal certification in weeks. They cannot get HPB endorsement in weeks. These moats are time-based. Moving first matters.

Risk 5. Brand Confusion Between Ember Kitchen and Qiko

Likelihood. Low to medium. If the separation is not clean, customers may associate Qiko with corporate catering.

Impact. Moderate. Undermines the entire purpose of the rebrand.

Response. Complete visual separation from day one. Separate website, separate social accounts, separate packaging. The Ember Kitchen name can appear on the "About Us" page and in the small print (for food safety and certification transparency), but nowhere in the customer-facing brand experience.

14. Conclusion

Ember Kitchen Catering has a good product sitting in the wrong wrapper. Healthy Tingkat is not failing because the food is bad or the price is wrong. It is failing because nobody can find it. The website is B2B. The social media is B2B. The name sounds like a cheaper version of something that already exists. The brand works against the product at every touchpoint.

Qiko fixes that. It gives the product its own identity, its own voice, and its own channels. It positions the brand in a competitive gap (halal-certified, HPB-endorsed, mid-range pricing) that nobody else currently occupies. It expands the product range to address different segments (fitness, customisation, retail). It builds distribution beyond a single website. And it does all of this on infrastructure that already exists.

The financial picture is realistic. S\$32,000 in Year 1 marketing spend, potentially offset by up to S\$35,000 in HPB grants. Revenue targets of S\$380,000 in Year 1 and S\$800,000 in Year 2 are grounded in conservative subscriber growth assumptions. The kitchen has capacity. The certification is in place. The delivery network is operational.

The risks are manageable. HPB grants might not come through, so the plan works without them. Retail might take longer, so the DTC channel carries Year 1. Churn is high in meal subscriptions, so the product strategy is built around variety and customisation. Competitors might respond, so the moats are structural (halal certification, HPB endorsement, kitchen infrastructure) rather than cosmetic.

What Ember Kitchen needs is not more time, more data, or more deliberation. The market is growing. The competitors are established but not dominant. The product is ready. What it needs now is a brand that matches the quality of the food.

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